

Install PuTTY on your local computer: Download and install the latest version of PuTTY from the PuTTY download page. Currently, the latest version of PuTTY is 0.74.

Converting a private key using PuTTYgen

PuTTY does not natively support the private key format for SSH keys. It provides a tool named PuTTYgen, which converts keys to the required format for PuTTY. You must follow the steps given below to convert your private key (.pem file) into this format (.ppk file), in order to connect to your instance using PuTTY.

- From the *Start* menu, choose *All Programs > PuTTY > PuTTYgen*.
- Under the type of key to generate, choose RSA. If you're using an older version of PuTTYgen, choose SSH-2 RSA.
- Load the .pem file. By default, PuTTYgen displays only files with the extension .ppk. To locate your .pem file, choose the option to display files of all types.
- Select your .pem file for the key pair that you specified when you launched your instance, and choose *Open*. PuTTYgen displays a message that the .pem file has been successfully imported. Choose *OK*.
- To save the key in the format that PuTTY can use, choose *Save private key*. PuTTYgen displays a warning about saving the key without a passphrase. Choose *Yes*.
- Specify the same name for the key that you used for the key pair (in our case *hadoopec2cluster.ppk*) and choose *Save*. PuTTY automatically adds the .ppk file extension.

Connecting to Amazon EC2 Linux instance

Now from your Windows system, use the following procedure to connect to your Amazon EC2 Linux instance using PuTTY. You need the .ppk file that you created for your private key.

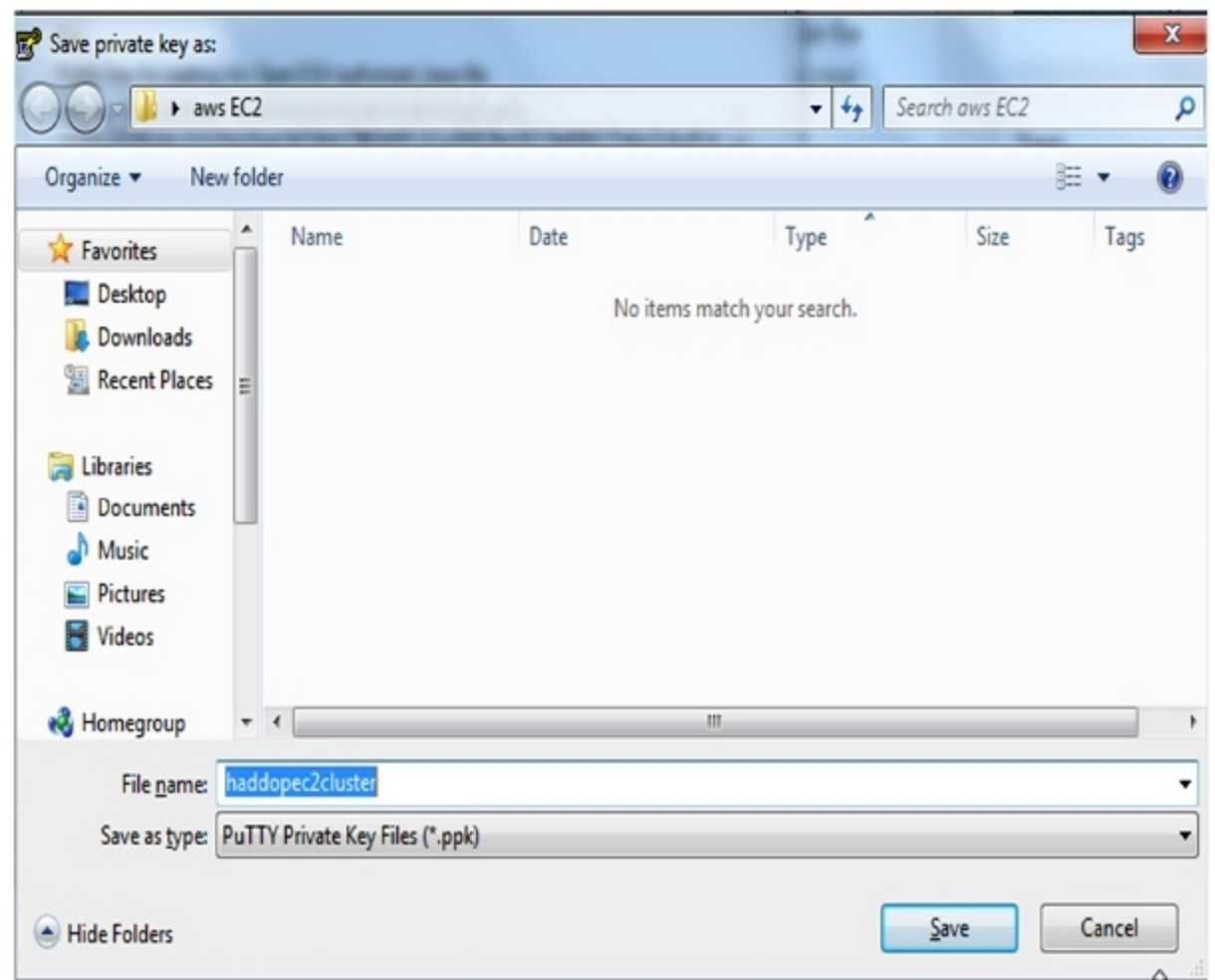


Figure 2: Save private key in .ppk format

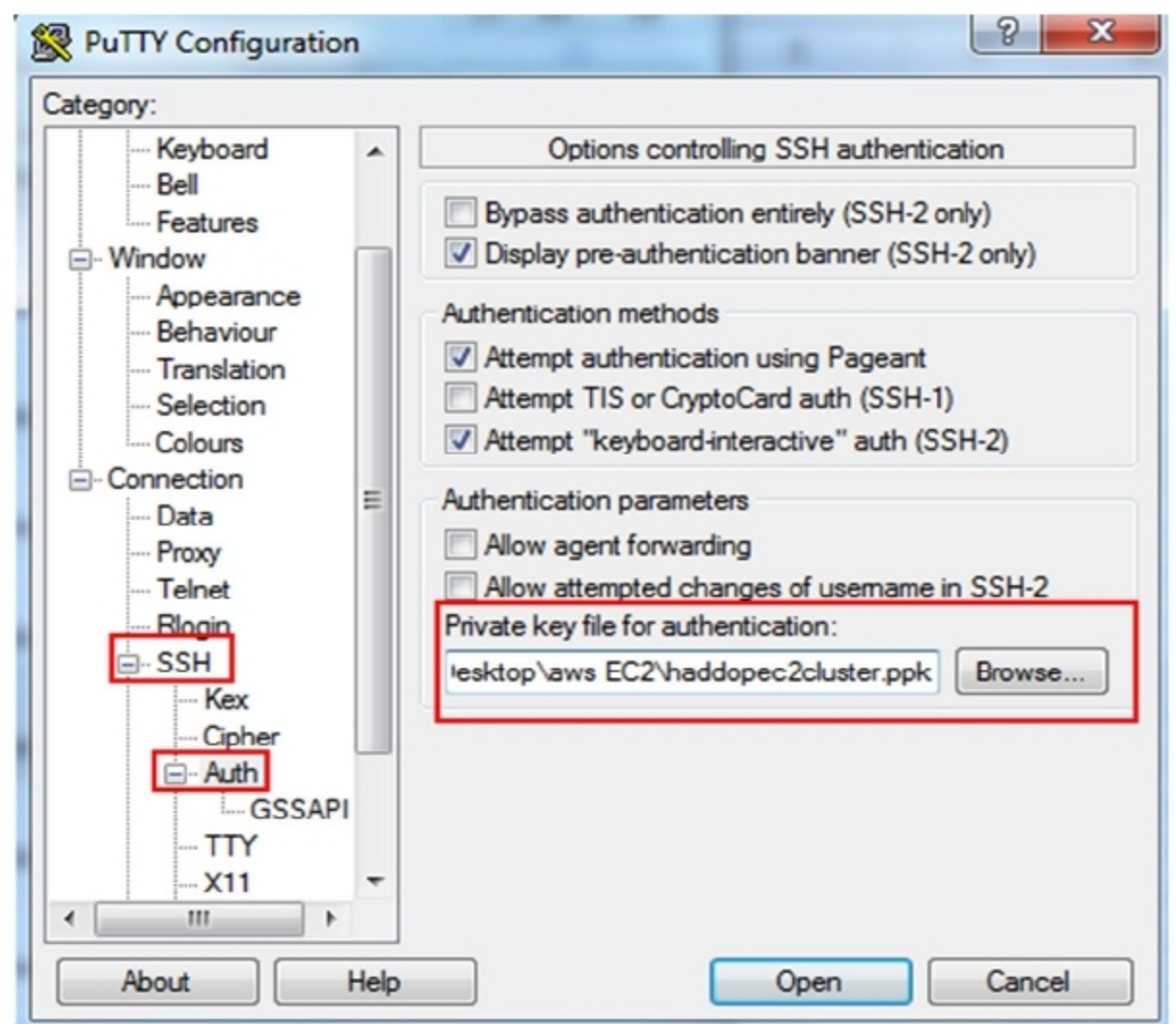


Figure 3: Connection type SSH and Auth

- Start PuTTY (from the *Start* menu, choose *All Programs > PuTTY*).
- In the *Category* pane, choose a session

and complete the following fields:

- In the *Host Name* box, write the public DNS name of your running instance.